SAAN ISAAC GEORGE

Head of Talent | HR Business Partner | AI-Enabled People Strategy
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

HR leader with 8+ years across EdTech, QSR, EV, consulting and retail who builds and ships: AI hiring and onboarding tools, incentive plans and leadership programmes that move revenue, speed and engagement. Works side by side with founders and CXOs, makes the call and owns the result end to end.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **$200-300K added revenue per quarter:** redesigned Sales incentives around Contribution Margin; productivity rose 10-15% and incentive costs fell by ~$100K.
- **3 months, ~470 people, 2 AI tools:** at California Burrito, hired ~70 corporate roles, onboarded ~400 store staff and shipped an AI-enabled ATS and onboarding app.
- **Screening cut from 2-3 hours to 20 minutes** per role per day with a custom AI-enabled ATS handling 12,600+ applications in 8 weeks.
- **4x faster onboarding:** 40 to 10 minutes per joiner for ~200 frontline joiners a month, saving ~100 hours monthly.
- **HR response time cut 65%** via an in-house AI coaching platform; employees rating their performance conversations effective rose from 20% to 30% company-wide.
- **30% of Director+ leaders moved up** after a 2-cohort programme for ~20 leaders across India, US and APAC.
- **Sales engagement up from 3.0 to 4.6** (out of 5) over 3 years, above the company average.

CORE SKILLS

HR Business Partnering · Talent Strategy · Organisation Design · Incentive & Reward Design · Leadership Development · Performance Management · Talent Acquisition · M&A Integration · People Analytics (Power BI) · Building HR Tools with AI (Claude)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of HR

California Burrito · QSR chain, 150+ stores, ~3,000 employees · Jul 2026 – Sep 2026

- Owned HR end to end across 150+ stores, from hiring and labour compliance to reporting, and set up statutory compliance accountability at every site.
- Hired ~70 corporate roles in 2 months across IT, AI Engineering, Supply Chain, Finance, Marketing and Store Operations.
- Built a custom ATS with Claude: source tracking, outcome-based shortlisting, an audit trail per hire and AI pre-assessment of reasoning and aptitude.
- Gave the CEO an AI analysis of 12,600+ applications across 25 roles, pinpointing sourcing and conversion gaps as weekly applications grew 5x.
- Shipped a frontline onboarding app that auto-reads Aadhaar and bank details from ID cards and cheques, with OTP verification, face capture and uniform sizing, synced to Keka.
- Launched Management Trainee and internship programmes and rewrote job descriptions across functions.

Associate Director, Talent Management & HR Business Partner

Emeritus (EdTech, 3,000+ employees) · Bengaluru, covering India, US and APAC · 2021 – Jul 2026 · Reported to Head of Talent Management / CHRO · Team of 4

- Partnered with Sales, Revenue, Tech and Delivery leaders for ~1,000 employees.
- Replaced a tenure-based Sales incentive plan with one tied to Contribution Margin and input metrics; payout data now feeds performance decisions.
- Designed and ran the Director+ leadership programme across 2 cohorts in India, US and APAC.
- Built a Sales career framework that created a pipeline of team leads, opened interim-manager roles and fixed a base-heavy structure.
- Hired 20-30 roles a month, cut Sales Advisor time-to-hire to 2 weeks and met the 5% PwD hiring target.
- Built an AI coaching and feedback platform for managers and senior leaders, integrated with the HRMS.
- Drove Revenue team productivity studies that set headcount allocation and hiring budgets.

- Led HR integration for cross-border acquisitions and rolled out OKR-based performance management across business units.

Talent Consultant
PwC Acceleration Center · Bengaluru, covering India, Shanghai and Colombia · Jul 2020 – Dec 2021

- Led the Talent Consulting team through a leadership transition, aligning priorities with Senior Partners.
- Built the Power BI talent dashboard Partners used in quarterly talent reviews.
- Benchmarked Tech Consulting pay with Korn Ferry, leading to recalibrated offer bands.
- Designed and launched a global Recognition & Rewards framework for consulting teams.

Talent Partner
Ather Energy (EV technology, Series C+) · Bengaluru · Apr 2018 – Jul 2020

- Built performance management from scratch for ~400 employees with the CTO and CHRO.
- Hired a batch of 20 Graduate Engineer Trainees across 10 IITs.
- Co-designed the new-joiner assimilation framework during rapid scale-up.

Senior Merchandise Specialist
Target Corporation (Fortune 50 retail) · Bengaluru · May 2012 – Jun 2015

- Automated 3 merchandising and forecasting processes in VBA, saving 2,820 hours a year.

EDUCATION

- PGDM, Human Resource Management & Strategy, T.A. Pai Management Institute (TAPMI), Manipal, 2018
- BBM, Human Resources, Christ University, Bengaluru, 2012

EXECUTIVE EDUCATION

Columbia Business School: Corporate Governance (2025) · Wharton: High-Impact Teams (2024), Talent Management (2023) · Cambridge: People Analytics (2022)